

Board 1

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 6 5 2

♥ 10

♦ J 10 7 2

♣ A 9 6

♠ 4

♥ K Q 9 8 6 2

♦ 8 6 3

♣ 10 7 5



♠ K Q 3

♥ A 5 4

♦ A 9 4

♣ K 8 3 2

♠ A J 9 7

♥ J 7 3

♦ K Q 5

♣ Q J 4

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

Pass

Dbl

Pass

2♣

Pass

2♥

All Pass

2♥ by North

Lead: ♠K

In the balancing seat it is distribution that counts, not point count. With a 6-card Major suit and a singleton you should not let them play 1NT. You double.

Partner makes the relay bid of 2♣.

You bid your suit, 2♥, and everybody passes. Notice that partner had a decent hand, but could not bid over 1NT in the immediate seat.

Board 2

East Deals

None Vul

♠ J 10 9 5 4

♥ A 10 7 4

♦ K 8 2

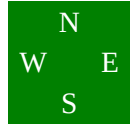
♣ 8

♠ K 2

♥ 6 3

♦ 7 5 3

♣ K J 9 6 5 3



♠ Q 6

♥ K Q 9

♦ A J 10

♣ A 10 7 4 2

♠ A 8 7 3

♥ J 8 5 2

♦ Q 9 6 4

♣ Q

West

North

East

South

Pass

Dbl

Pass

2♣

All Pass

2♣ by South

Lead: ♣8

You don't have a 6-card suit, nor do you have a 5-4 pair of suits. So even with a singleton you don't want to use DONT here. So you pass.

Partner makes a DONT double in the balancing seat.

Right now you probably have a premonition about what is going to happen next. But there really is nothing you can say other than 2♣.

Your premonition came true. Partner passes and you are left playing 2♣ with a singleton. Nobody promised that DONT would always get you to a good contract.

Board 3

East Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 10 7 3 2

♥ —

♦ K J 8 4 3 2

♣ 4

♠ J 4

♥ K Q J 10 7 4 3

♦ 7 5

♣ 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 9 6

♥ A 9 6 5

♦ A Q

♣ Q 10 7 5

♠ 8 5

♥ 8 2

♦ 10 9 6

♣ A K J 9 8 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♥

All Pass

2♥ by North

Lead: ♥5

1NT

Dbl

You only have 8 HCP but with such a good 6-card suit you should interfere with a DONT bid. You double and partner surprises you by saying 2♥.

There is a reason partner didn't say 2♣ (which you were going to pass). And the reason is that he figures you will be better off in his ♥s. Since you trust your partner you pass.

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

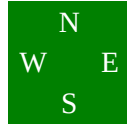
♠ 9 5 4 2
 ♥ 9 3
 ♦ J 8 3
 ♣ Q 10 6 2

♠ 7

♥ Q J 8 2

♦ K Q 10 7 4

♣ 9 7 3



♠ A 10 6

♥ K 5

♦ A 9 5 2

♣ A J 5 4

♠ K Q J 8 3

♥ A 10 7 6 4

♦ 6

♣ K 8

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

2♥

Pass

3♥

Pass

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by South

Lead: ♣6

Since partner has entered the bidding in the immediate seat he should have a pretty good hand, with 9+ cards in ♥s and ♠s.

Usually you are happy to settle for partscore after a DONT sequence, but with such an excellent fit for ♥s your hand is worth a raise.

So you bid 3♥ and partner says 4♥.

Board 5

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 5 4
 ♥ J 5 2
 ♦ J 10 7 4 3
 ♣ Q 4 2

♠ A 10 3 2

♥ 6 4

♦ 9 8

♣ K 10 9 7 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 8 7

♥ A Q 10 8

♦ K 2

♣ A J 6 3

♠ K J 9 6

♥ K 9 7 3

♦ A Q 6 5

♣ 8

You have only 7 HCP but expect partner to have a reasonable hand since West could not keep the bidding open. With your black 2-suiter you bid the lowest one, 2♣.

Partner says 2♦.

Partner's 2♦ bid, the next suit up the line, asks you to name your other suit (or pass if your other suit is ♦s).

You bid 2♠ and everybody passes.

West	North	East	South
		1NT	Pass
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♦
Pass	2♠		
All Pass			
2♠ by North			
Lead: ♣A			

Board 6

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 9 4
 ♥ A 4 2
 ♦ K J 9 4 2
 ♣ A K

♠ A J 7 3
 ♥ K Q 9
 ♦ A Q 8 6
 ♣ 6 3



♠ —
 ♥ 10 8 7 5
 ♦ 7 3
 ♣ Q J 10 9 5 4 2

♠ K 10 8 6 5 2
 ♥ J 6 3
 ♦ 10 5
 ♣ 8 7

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	Pass	2♠
Pass	4♠		
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♣A			

You would have opened 1NT but West beat you to it. You cannot double for penalties when you use DONT, so you pass.

Partner bids 2♠ in the balancing seat.

The 2♠ bid shows a weak hand, with more strength partner would have first doubled, then bid 2♠.

Still, you know he has a 6-card suit and you also know that every finesse is going to work. You either bid 3♠ or 4♠. Be bold.